

BanglaRhet Annotation Guidelines

Guidelines for Rhetorical Technique and Persuasion Technique Annotation

Dataset: BanglaRhet — Bangla Political Speech Rhetoric and Persuasion Dataset

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Dataset DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.23162113

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1. Purpose and Scope

These guidelines define how Bangla political speech segments are annotated with two independent labels: `rhetorical_technique` and `persuasion_technique`. The goal is to identify the dominant rhetorical device and dominant persuasive strategy expressed in each segment.

The annotation task is linguistic and analytical. Annotators should describe what the segment does rhetorically or persuasively rather than judge whether the political claim is true, reasonable, or desirable.

2. Annotation Unit

Each dataset row represents one Bangla political speech segment manually extracted from publicly accessible news material. A segment is included when it contains a direct quotation or a reported statement attributable to a political figure or political institution by name, role, or position. When the speaker's identity cannot be determined, the segment is retained and the speaker is recorded as `unknown_speaker`.

Each segment receives exactly one rhetorical label and exactly one persuasion label. The two labels are assigned independently; a segment may therefore receive, for example, Metaphor as its rhetorical label and Blame Assignment as its persuasion label.

3. General Annotation Procedure

Step	Guidance
Read the complete segment	Read the entire segment before choosing either label.
Identify the main communicative pattern	Ask what linguistic/rhetorical device is most salient and what persuasive strategy, if any, is most salient.
Select one rhetorical label	Choose the single dominant rhetorical technique from the defined label set.
Select one persuasion label	Choose the single dominant persuasion technique from the defined label set.
Use None when appropriate	Do not force a technique when the segment does not clearly satisfy one of the categories.
Resolve ambiguity consistently	When multiple labels appear plausible, apply the dominance rules below rather than assigning multiple labels.

4. Rhetorical Technique Labels

Contrast

Presents opposing ideas, positions, situations, or outcomes to create rhetorical contrast.

Emotional Language

Uses emotionally charged language intended to evoke an emotional response.

Repetition

Repeats words, phrases, or structures for rhetorical emphasis.

Exaggeration

Uses deliberate overstatement or hyperbolic expression.

Anecdote

Uses a short personal, historical, or illustrative account to support the message.

Rhetorical Question

Uses a question primarily for emphasis or persuasion rather than to obtain an answer.

Metaphor

Uses figurative comparison or metaphorical language to communicate an idea.

Parallelism

Uses repeated grammatical or structural patterns for rhetorical effect.

None

No clearly identifiable rhetorical technique, or the segment does not clearly satisfy one of the defined categories.

5. Persuasion Technique Labels

Blame Assignment

Attributes responsibility, fault, or negative consequences to a person, group, organization, or political opponent.

Call to Action

Encourages the audience to take a specific action or engage in a particular behavior.

Unity Call

Appeals for collective unity, solidarity, cooperation, or shared identity.

Emotional Appeal

Persuades primarily by appealing to emotions.

Moral Appeal

Appeals to moral principles, duties, values, justice, or ethical obligations.

Logical Appeal

Attempts to persuade through reasoning, evidence, cause-and-effect relationships, or logical argumentation.

None

No clearly identifiable persuasion technique, or the segment does not clearly satisfy one of the defined categories.

6. Important Boundary Rules

Emotional Language vs. Emotional Appeal

Emotional Language is a rhetorical form: focus on emotionally charged wording or expression.

Emotional Appeal is a persuasive function: focus on using emotion as the primary means of persuading the audience. A segment can therefore have Emotional Language as its rhetorical label and Emotional Appeal as its persuasion label.

Rhetorical Question vs. Call to Action

A question framed for emphasis rather than an actual answer is a Rhetorical Question. If the segment primarily instructs or urges the audience to take an action, use Call to Action as the persuasion label. The presence of a question alone does not make a segment a Call to Action.

Contrast vs. Blame Assignment

Use Contrast when the key rhetorical feature is the juxtaposition of opposing ideas or situations. Use Blame Assignment when the key persuasive function is attributing responsibility or fault. Both can legitimately apply to the same segment, one as each of the two independent labels.

Repetition vs. Parallelism

Repetition focuses on recurring words, phrases, or expressions. Parallelism focuses on repeated grammatical or structural patterns. When both seem plausible, select the one that best represents the dominant rhetorical construction.

Exaggeration

Use Exaggeration when the wording deliberately overstates a quantity, condition, consequence, or characterization. Do not label a statement Exaggeration merely because it is politically strong or controversial.

Metaphor

Use Metaphor when an idea is communicated through a figurative comparison or transfer of meaning. Ordinary literal descriptions should not be labeled Metaphor.

Anecdote

Use Anecdote when a short personal, historical, or illustrative account is used as part of the message. A simple factual statement about an event is not automatically an Anecdote.

7. Dominant-Label Rule

Political speech often contains several rhetorical or persuasive techniques simultaneously. BanglaRhet uses a single dominant label for each annotation dimension rather than multi-label annotation.

When several candidates are present:

- Choose the technique that is most salient to the segment's wording or communicative function.
- Prefer a clearly evidenced technique over one that requires substantial interpretation.
- For persuasion, consider the primary intended persuasive function of the segment.
- For rhetoric, consider the most prominent linguistic or structural device.
- Do not select a label simply because the segment could be interpreted as containing it; there should be textual evidence.

8. When to Use None

Use None when no defined technique can be identified with reasonable confidence. None is also appropriate for a borderline case that does not clearly satisfy a single category.

Annotators should not force a label merely because every row must receive a category. The None class is intentionally retained to represent ordinary or non-technique-bearing speech.

9. Annotation Quality and Disagreement

Two annotators manually annotated the corpus. A pilot subset was jointly annotated before large-scale annotation to establish shared label boundaries, particularly for Emotional Language versus Emotional Appeal. These guidelines were compiled from the label definitions and boundary rules agreed during the pilot annotation and consensus discussions.

Inter-annotator agreement was measured on a random subset of 500 segments before consensus resolution, and indicates moderate-to-substantial agreement:

Task	Cohen's κ
Rhetorical technique	0.67
Persuasion technique	0.71

Disagreements in the full annotation process were resolved through discussion. The purpose of consensus was to produce a single final dominant label per dimension.

10. Data Collection and Processing Notes

The corpus was manually extracted from publicly accessible Bangla political news material covering 2014–2025. Unknown speakers were retained as `unknown_speaker`. Journalistic analysis/background/non-political commentary was excluded except where a segment was retained and labeled `None`.

Passages exceeding 128 tokens were manually condensed while preserving relevant rhetorical and persuasive content. The exact proportion of manually condensed passages was not logged.

For the experimental benchmark reported in the accompanying paper, Parallelism was excluded because it had only 137 instances, and controlled downsampling was applied, producing 22,565 samples. The released full corpus contains 30,289 segments.

11. Recommended Annotation Checklist

- ☐ Have I read the whole segment?
- ☐ Is there clear textual evidence for the selected rhetorical label?
- ☐ Is there clear evidence for the selected persuasion label?
- ☐ If multiple techniques exist, did I choose the dominant one?
- ☐ Am I confusing emotionally charged language with emotional persuasion?
- ☐ Am I labeling a literal statement as metaphor or exaggeration without sufficient evidence?
- ☐ Would `None` be more appropriate than forcing a weak label?
- ☐ Am I judging the political claim instead of analyzing its linguistic/rhetorical function?

12. Ethical and Copyright Note

The dataset analyzes linguistic and rhetorical patterns in publicly accessible political speech material. It does not endorse, rank, or determine the truthfulness of political individuals, parties, groups, or claims.

The source-derived speech text may contain third-party material. The dataset authors do not claim ownership of copyright held by original publishers or other third parties. The annotation guidelines and other original contributions made by the dataset authors are separate from rights in third-party source material and are released under CC BY 4.0.

For research use, retain source information where available and consult the applicable rights and legal exceptions for any third-party material.

13. Dataset Reference

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Zenodo DOI: [10.5281/zenodo.23162113](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23162113)

This document describes the annotation scheme used for the BanglaRhet dataset. It is intended to accompany the dataset release and support reproducible annotation and downstream research.